

Request for Proposal
RFP No. 041725SS

Inbound Freight Management Services
For
The University of Pittsburgh

Issue Date: April 17, 2025

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ISSUE DATE: April 17, 2025

RFP No. 041725SS

ISSUING OFFICE:

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TITLE: REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL – INBOUND FREIGHT MANAGEMENT SERVICES

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. Purpose

The University of Pittsburgh – Of the Commonwealth System of Higher Education (referred to herein as the "University of Pittsburgh" or the "University") is accepting proposals from qualified Contractors to provide inbound freight management services, as outlined in this Request for Proposal (RFP).

The purpose of this RFP is to identify a Contractor capable of managing the University's inbound freight program to ensure cost efficiency, timely delivery, streamlined operations, excellent customer service, and enhanced visibility into shipment tracking, invoicing, and freight activity.

The selected Contractor will be expected to provide discounted pricing and value-added services for small parcel and less-than-truckload (LTL) shipments. Such as multi carrier support and execution, invoice and payment services (Freight audit and pay), supplier management and program support, customer support, reporting and analytics. In addition, the supplier should support the University's goals to optimize freight spend, improve participating supplier compliance, convert unmanaged suppliers to the program, increase utilization, track and report performance metrics and more.

The University is also interested in exploring volume-based discounts, customized reporting capabilities, and a freight management solution that integrates with existing systems and improves overall operational efficiency. This RFP outlines the specific requirements, terms, and conditions to guide the preparation of a detailed and professional proposal.

Inbound Freight Management Program Overview

The University currently operates an inbound freight management program across multiple campuses, including the main campus in Pittsburgh and several regional campuses. The vast majority of inbound shipments (approximately 99%) are directed at the main campus or in the general surrounding area.

Pittsburgh Main Campus
(Oakland) – 4200 Fifth Ave, Pittsburgh, PA 15260 (Numerous buildings in general area).

Regional Campuses
Pitt-Greensburg - 150 Finoli Dr, Greensburg, PA 15601
Pitt Johnstown - 450 Schoolhouse Rd, Johnstown, PA 15904
Pitt Bradford - 300 Campus Dr, Bradford, PA 16701
Pitt Titusville - 504 E Main St, Titusville, PA 16354

Annual Avg Spend	Shipments Past Year	(SP) Small Parcel	(LTL) Less-than-Truckload	Participating Suppliers
$434,000	11,646	11,532	114	240+

Note* *In the past year 54% of shipments were ground, 46% of shipments were air. These figures represent a very reliable estimate based on actual shipping activity and spend over the past year. While there may be some fluctuations year by year, this provides a solid benchmark for recent typical volume and activity.*

There are currently 240+ suppliers participating in the University's inbound freight management program. The majority of these are small to medium-sized scientific and medical suppliers. As the program matures, the University is interested in expanding participation to include a broader range of supplier types beyond medical and scientific, with a goal of increasing overall program adoption.

Current Invoicing Process

For participating suppliers, purchase orders generated in PantherExpress are exported daily to the freight management provider, who then matches Purchase Order (PO) data to corresponding shipment records. On a weekly basis, the provider compiles invoice data into Excel files separately for LTL shipments and FedEx small parcel, that include detailed shipment, billing, and cost center information. These files are submitted every week to the University's secure SFTP server for automated ingestion into the Prism interface.

Upon submission, Oracle generates either a "Successful" or "Failure" email notification. Failures typically result from inactive or closed GL account codes, which cause the entire file to be rejected. When this occurs, the provider contacts the purchase order owner to update the account information before resubmitting the corrected file. Once successfully imported into Prism, the Payment Processing team performs an open payable import process, receives the Excel and PDF invoice copies via a shared mailbox, and completes a spot audit and invoice validation prior to payment.

Note* *PantherExpress is the cloud-based purchasing tool and preferred procurement and payment mechanism for most goods and services purchased at the University. PRISM is the University's financial ERP system, used for processing invoices and payments. It is built on Oracle's E-Business Suite, which serves as the underlying enterprise software platform. "GL" General Ledger.*

Outbound Freight Management Services (Out of Scope)

Outbound freight management services are currently out of scope for this RFP. However, the University is interested in exploring outbound freight solutions following the successful implementation of the new inbound freight management program.

Note: *In FY24, outbound freight spend totaled approximately $1.1 million, including UPS and FedEx shipments, but excluding University Stores. When including University Stores, total outbound freight spend was approximately $1.3 million.*

1.2. Background Information

The University is a 403(b) non-profit, nonsectarian, coeducational, state-related, public research university. The University is comprised of five campuses located throughout western Pennsylvania with an operating budget in excess of $3.0 billion and more than $1 billion in sponsored research. The University of Pittsburgh is accredited by the Middle States Association of Colleges and Schools and additionally by various specialized accrediting Contractors. It is a member of the Association of American Universities, which is an organization comprised of 63 leading doctorate-granting research institutions in the United States and Canada.

Since its founding in 1787, the University of Pittsburgh has established itself as the most comprehensive educational complex in the region. It provides a wide range of academic programs and services for the Pittsburgh metropolitan area's population of 2.4 million. The University enrolls approximately 32,000 students, and it employs more than 12,000 faculty members, research associates, and staff.

1.3. Additional Information

All proposals become the property of the University of Pittsburgh upon receipt. The opening of proposals will be a private session. To the extent reasonably possible, the University shall keep all proposals received confidential. Contractors will not receive any compensation or reimbursement of expenses for submitting a proposal pursuant to this RFP. All costs incurred in connection with this RFP are Contractor's sole responsibility. The University reserves the right to investigate and/or require additional information deemed pertinent by the University to fully evaluate its proposal.

Contractor, by submitting a response to this RFP, certifies that this proposal was prepared and submitted without collusion with any other Contractor or employee of the University of Pittsburgh.

The University of Pittsburgh reserves the right to reject any or all proposals; to waive any informality in proposals; to negotiate with any or all Contractors, and, unless otherwise specified by Contractor, to accept any services contained in any proposal. The University reserves the right to add and/or delete any or all of the services requested. If a proposal is deemed acceptable by the University in its sole discretion, the University and the successful Contractor shall in good faith commence preparation of a definitive agreement (the "Definitive Agreement").

Proposal responses must be signed by an authorized officer of the Contractor to bind Contractor to the proposal's provisions. Proposals must remain in effect for a minimum period of one hundred eighty (180) calendar days as of the response date specified herein.

Contractor warrants that the prices for any goods/services identified in its response are not less favorable than those extended to any other customer (whether government or commercial) for the same or similar services in comparable situations.

By submitting their proposals, Contractors certify that they do not and will not during the performance of this agreement employ, recruit or refer for employment illegal alien workers or otherwise violate the provisions of section 274a Federal Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986.

1.4. Timeline

Completed By:	Key Milestones	Comments
04/11/2025	Pre-solicitation Meeting	Optional, virtual meeting. Link to be provided.
04/17/2025	Distribution of the RFP	Electronic copies of the RFP will be distributed to Contractors.
04/24/2025	Final pre-proposal questions send to: jtr117@pitt.edu	Each Contractor may submit one set of pre-proposal questions. Please consolidate all questions into a single email and submit by 11:59pm (Eastern Time) via email to jtr117@pitt.edu in the following format. 1. Vendor must reference the specific section and item number to which the question applies. 2. Reference to a specific sentence within a request section, if applicable, by including the specific sentence in question. 3. Contractors must include a single name, email address and daytime telephone number of the person to be contacted in the event University of Pittsburgh requires further clarification of the question. Due to the short turnaround time for providing answers to your questions, University of Pittsburgh prefers that this be the person from whom the question originated.
04/25/2025	Notification of interest to Participate Form Due via email to jtr117@pitt.edu	Contractors must provide Participation Confirmation Form no later than Noon (Eastern Time) to the University.
04/29/2025	Responses to Questions emailed to all participants by end of business day.	Responses to all questions emailed to all participants.
05/02/2025	Proposals due via email to jtr117@pitt.edu	Contractors must provide the response to the RFP no later than Noon (Eastern Time) to the University. Please follow submission instructions in section 4 of the RFP PDF document.
05/13/2025 – 5/15/2025	Virtual finalist interviews/Presentations.	If selected, Contractors will be reached out to via email to schedule.
06/01/2025 (On or before)	Notification of Provisional Award	
06/11/2025	Target Start of Implementation Activities, Including Contract Execution	

The University reserves the right to amend this schedule as it deems necessary.

1.5. General Submission Requirements

Notification of Intent to Participate - All Contractors must complete and return via email the **Notification of Interest to Participate Form**, attached hereto as Excel document titled: **Attachment A_Inbound Freight Management Services RFP – Notification of Interest to Participate Form.** Please complete the form in the original Excel format. Submit this document by itself (no additional files) via email to jtr117@pitt.edu and CC ccyphert@cfo.pitt.edu. **No later than noon Eastern Time on April 25, 2025.**

This form confirms that Contractor either who intends to participate and has received all of the materials and that all of the proposal requirements are understood and agreed to prior to preparation and submission of a proposal or that Contractor does not intend to participate and has notified the University that it declines to submit a proposal. Failure by a Contractor to either respond to or decline this RFP may result in Contractor being eliminated as a potential participant in connection with future requests for proposals by the University.

Detailed Submission Requirements - In order to receive consideration, responses to this RFP must follow the Detailed Submission Requirements set forth in Section 4 of this RFP.

Proposal Submissions - Contractors should submit **one (1)** electronic copy sent through email **no later than noon Eastern Time on May 2, 2025.** The proposals should be delivered to: jtr117@pitt.edu and CC ccyphert@cfo.pitt.edu

Proposals received at any other University office will not be considered. Please direct all questions concerning this RFP, in writing, to the RFP Coordinator identified on page three. Attempts to gain additional information by any other method may result in disqualification of Contractor. No party may meet privately with employees, officers or other representatives of the University to discuss any aspect of this RFP or Contractor's proposal.

Proposals received after the deadline may be rejected at the sole discretion of the University. The University assumes no responsibility for late delivery, for any reason whatsoever (i.e., weather or traffic conditions, illness, accident, delivery to wrong location, courier problems).

It is the objective of the University to obtain information from each Contractor that is uniform and complete. In order to evaluate each option in an efficient manner and to determine which Contractor is best able to meet all of the criteria being considered, information submitted for this RFP must follow the timeline and the specifications outlined below. The University, at any time and in its sole discretion, may amend or supplement the provisions of this RFP.

The University is under no obligation, either expressed or implied, to contract for any products or services as a result of this RFP. This RFP does not constitute an agreement on the part of the University to consummate any of the transactions contemplated hereby, and any such agreement is expressly conditioned on and subject to the mutual execution and delivery by the University and the successful Contractor of the Definitive Agreement. Each Contractor hereby acknowledges and agrees not to maintain any claims or institute any proceedings seeking to establish that any binding contractual relationship exists between it and the University with respect to this RFP.

1.6. Proprietary Information and Disclosure

Contractor agrees that any information disclosed by the University to Contractor for the purpose of this RFP shall be used only to complete Contractor's proposal. Contractor will keep the information confidential, will not disclose it to any third party, except as authorized by the University or as required by law, and will only disclose it to those within its organization who need to complete the proposal. Upon completion or termination of this proposal, Contractor shall return all such information to the University, or make such other disposition thereof as may be directed or approved by the University. No item furnished under this

RFP, or products, plans, designs, or specifications for producing the same, which have been specifically designed for or by the University, shall be duplicated or used by Contractor. Contractor agrees that it will not, without prior written approval of the University, publicize this RFP or disclose, confirm or deny any details thereof to third parties, or use the University's name in connection with Contractor's sales promotion or publicity without prior written approval from the University. Nothing in this provision shall restrict Contractor's right to use or disclose any information which is or becomes generally known to the public without breach of this provision by Contractor, or is rightfully obtained without restriction from other sources.

1.7. University Policies and Procedures

It is incumbent upon all Contractors to familiarize themselves with the University's policies and procedures prior to the submission of a response to this RFP (i.e., non-discrimination, equal opportunity and affirmative action, sexual harassment, licensing and use of publisher name/logo, smoking, drug-free workplace/drug-free school). Contractors may access these policies at https://www.ppt.pitt.edu/suppliers/info-suppliers

1.8. Agreement/University's Standard Terms and Conditions

The intent of this RFP and the ensuing process is to provide companies with the information, requirements, and specifications necessary for the preparation of a professional and comprehensive proposal. Specific terms and conditions are outlined.

A Definitive Agreement shall be negotiated as part of the award process applicable to this RFP. The University may choose to use a form of Contracted Supplier Agreement attached as Attachment I. The University, however, may at its discretion choose to use a different form of agreement after reviewing the submitted proposals.

In the event that goods are to be included in the Definitive Agreement, the University's Standard Terms and Conditions may also apply and can be found at https://www.ppt.pitt.edu/sites/default/files/tc.pdf

Contractors are asked to become familiar with these documents and note exceptions to these terms and conditions in writing as part of Contractor's response to this RFP. The acceptance of these terms and conditions is a component of the award criteria. The University may require additional modifications/additions to these terms depending on, at a minimum, research requirements, final product selection, and facility concerns.

1.9. RFP Coordinator

The RFP Coordinator for this RFP is John Richey. All communication with the University regarding this RFP shall only be directed to the RFP Coordinator via email jtr117@pitt.edu, and Contractors shall CC ccyphert@cfo.pitt.edu on all submission and proposal forms.

1.10. Commercial Partnership

The University is interested in selectively establishing and strengthening business relationships with suppliers to the mutual benefit of both parties. Therefore, the University encourages Contractors to explore other ways to increase the value of the relationship between the University and itself.

Opportunities might include:

- Athletics (including naming rights)
- Branding and advertising
- eSports program sponsorship
- Fellowships

- Internships
- Personal Purchase Discount program (available to employees, students, alumni, fans)
- Philanthropy (scholarships, sponsorships)
- Research projects
- Or any other programs that add additional value to the relationship.

Contractors should familiarize themselves with the University's Commercial Partnership website and include value-add relationship ideas in the proposal with a description of any existing relationships and ideas for new or expanded engagement. The University offers to assist Contractors in the development and execution of these opportunities through the University's central corporate engagement staff at the Office of Economic Partnerships.

1.11. Utilization of Small and Local Businesses

In order to fulfill the third prong of the University's mission of teaching, research and community service, the University actively provides contracting opportunities to qualified small* and local** businesses. Purchasing from small and local businesses supports a strong, vibrant regional economy in which University students and employees live and work, local internships for University students, and local job opportunities for University alumni.

The University requires all Contractors to provide details on how their company's proposal supports the University's mission of community service, either directly or through tier two subcontractors, in Appendix E, Section - Other Information. Additionally, in order to fulfill this RFP requirement, Contractors are strongly encouraged to work with the University and regional organizations that provide assistance to small and local businesses, such as the University's Institute for Entrepreneurial Excellence, the Greater Pittsburgh Chamber of Commerce, PA Business One Stop Shop, the Pittsburgh African-American Chamber of Commerce, the Pittsburgh Hispanic Chamber of Commerce, the BEAM Pittsburgh anchor institution cooperative, the Cambria County, Westmoreland County, Bradford Area, and Meadville Chambers of Commerce. Questions concerning this requirement should be directed to the RFP Administrator.

* Small shall be as defined by the United States Small Business Administration – www.sba.gov/document/support-table-size-standards
** A local business is one within the 10 counties of Southwestern Pennsylvania as defined by the Allegheny Conference on Community Development - www.alleghenyconference.org

1.12. Inclusion of Sustainability

The University encourages Contractors to identify people, products, services or processes that support the University's commitment to environmental stewardship as outlined in the Pitt Sustainability Plan (https://www.sustainable.pitt.edu/pitt-sustainability-plan/). The University asks Contractors to consider Environmentally Preferred Purchasing ("EPP") in their proposals. Contractors should take into consideration the definition of EPP provided by the United States Environmental Protection Agency when preparing their responses.

Environmentally Preferred Purchasing is defined as products or services that have a lesser or reduced effect on human health and the environment when compared with competing products or services that serve the same purpose. The product or service comparison may consider raw materials acquisition, production, manufacturing, packaging, distribution, reuse, operation, maintenance or disposal. (EP 13101, Section 201).

Proposals with the attributes below are encouraged:

- Decrease waste or minimize energy demands
- Make use of post-consumer content
- Are recyclable/products with an end-of-life plan

- Are more easily repaired or updated (to avoid planned obsolescence)
- Come from more local sources or are domestically produced

Contractors should be sure to highlight if they:

- Have a written commitment to environmentally friendly practices and can demonstrate these values
- Use processes that do the least harm to the environment
- Provide an end-of-life plan or recycling/reusing options for their product
- Maintain their products while in the University's possession

Any environmental benefits provided, should be clearly identified and include supporting data. Benefits may include: reduced life cycle costs, reduced energy consumption, recycled content, overall recyclability, extended product life, and decreased maintenance.

1.13. Data Management & Security

Contractor may be asked to complete a data security assessment in coordination with the Pitt IT Third Party Vendor Security team. This determination is based on criteria such as data moving between the University and Contractor systems, system integrations, Contractor access to the University networks, and/or the University data being shared with the Contractor, whether the data is personal identifiable information, personal health information, or student data.

2. CONTRACTOR RESPONSIBILITIES AND QUALIFICATIONS

2.1. Services to be Provided

Contractor is to provide services and goods as identified on Appendix C, Scope of Work. Contractors may provide alternatives to this approach.

2.2. Qualifications

Contractor must be organized for the purpose of providing the services in a timely manner.

Contractor must have five years previous experience with providing comparable goods and services offerings.

Contractor must have a proven ability to start-up within 30 days of receipt of the Definitive Agreement, as evidenced by a signed Definitive Agreement.

Contractor must have qualified staff and equipment and materials to successfully complete the requirements. The University of Pittsburgh, at its discretion, may request an inspection of the Contractor's operation and personnel prior to execution of the Definitive Agreement.

Contractor must have the capability to supervise and monitor the process ensuring satisfactory provision of services.

Contractor shall submit a list of three (3) references of comparable services offering from **existing** customers, including name of business, address, and contact person and phone number (Appendix D, included in Attachment G)

Contractor shall submit a list of one (1) reference of comparable services offering from **previous** customers, including name of business, address, and contact person and phone number. A reason should be provided as to why Contractor believes the customer no longer is doing business with Contractor. Please do not

supply references if the previous customer left due to either customer's business closing or no longer required said service as part of their business (Appendix D, included in Attachment G).

No contract shall be made by Contractor with any party for furnishing any of the work or services herein contained without the prior written approval of the University of Pittsburgh RFP Coordinator. However, this provision shall not require the approval of contracts of employment between Contractor and personnel assigned for services there under, or for parties named in the proposal and agreed to under any resulting contract.

Contractor is, for purposes arising out of a Definitive Agreement, an Independent Contractor and shall not be deemed an employee of the University of Pittsburgh. It is expressly understood and agreed that Contractor shall in no event, as a result of a Definitive Agreement, be entitled to any benefits to which University of Pittsburgh employees are entitled, including but not limited to overtime, any retirement benefits, worker's compensation benefits, and injury leave or other leave benefits. Contractor hereby holds University of Pittsburgh harmless from any and all claims that may be made against University of Pittsburgh based upon any contention by any third party that an employer-employee relationship exists by reason of this agreement.

2.3. Contractor Responsibilities

Contractor shall furnish all necessary permits and insurance in its performance of the specifications.

Before commencement of the work, Contractor shall submit insurance policies or Certificates of Insurance evidencing that Contractor has obtained for the period of the Definitive Agreement, from companies authorized to transact business in Pennsylvania, insurance in the forms of coverage and minimum amounts specified below. Said insurance must contain an endorsement that the University of Pittsburgh is named as an additional insured in respect to the work covered hereunder and must provide that thirty days' notice be given to the University of Pittsburgh prior to cancellation or reduction in coverage of the policy. Certificates of insurance evidencing this coverage are required to be delivered to the RFP Coordinator prior to the commencement of work and approved by him/her.

A. WORKER'S COMPENSATION- Statutory (unlimited payments)

B. COMMERCIAL GENERAL LIABILITY
(1) $1,000,000 Each Occurrence;
(2) $2,000,000 General Aggregate
(3) $1,000,000 Products & Completed Operations Aggregate
(4) $1,000,000 Personal & Advertising Injury
(5) $100,000 Fire Damage (any one fire)
(6) $10,000 Medical Expense (any one person)

C. AUTOMOBILE LIABILITY
$1,000,000 Combined Single Limit for Bodily Injury and Property Damage per Accident Coverage to include hired car and non-owned automobiles

D. EMPLOYER'S LIABILITY
$1,000,000 Each Accident
$1,000,000 Disease – Policy Limit
$1,000,000 Disease – Each Employee

E. CYBER LIABILITY
$10,000,000

Contractor shall, at its own expense, protect, defend, indemnify and hold harmless the University of Pittsburgh from all claims, damages, costs, lawsuits and expenses including, but not limited to, all costs from administrative proceedings, court costs and attorney fees that the University of Pittsburgh incur as a result of any criminal acts, intentional torts, acts or omissions which by statute give rise to strict liability, negligent acts or omissions of Contractor, its officers, employees or agents which may arise out of the Definitive Agreement.

It shall be Contractor's responsibility to visit the job site to check any conditions that may affect its proposal. Claims for allowances due to Contractor's error or negligence, in acquainting themselves with the site, shall not be recognized. By Contractor's act of submitting a proposal, the Contractor acknowledges that it has informed itself of all conditions.

Contractor shall be responsible to conduct all necessary site inspections and reference work to meet all responsibilities of the specifications, including inspection of all physical space affected by the specifications to verify all existing materials, operational dimensions, conditions and scope.

If the Contractor fails to provide the service when required and the University contracts with an alternate Contractor to provide the service Contractor must reimburse the University the difference in rate, only if the alternate's rate is higher.

3. ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

3.1. Term

The term of the Definitive Agreement will be for five 5 years, with the option for two (2), one (1)-year extension by the University in its sole and absolute discretion. The University reserves the right to cancel the Definitive Agreement at any time during that period by giving Contractor thirty (30) days written notice.

3.2. Mergers/Acquisitions

Should Contractor be acquired by or merge with another entity during the RFP process, Contractor must immediately notify the RFP Coordinator. Included with the notification should be a letter reaffirming the terms and conditions of the RFP and signed by the principal of Contractor.

3.3. Non-Endorsement

If the proposal is accepted, Contractor shall not issue any news releases or other statements pertaining to the award or servicing of the Definitive Agreement that state or imply the University of Pittsburgh's endorsement of Contractor's services, without prior approval of the University of Pittsburgh.

3.4. Exceptions

Indicate any exceptions, exclusions, unusual cases or deviations from the specifications and requirements contained in this RFP. If no exceptions are to be included, the proposal should specify "none". Unless exceptions are stated in writing upon submission of proposal, the University of Pittsburgh assumes Contractor acceptance of the content of this RFP and any addenda thereto, if any, in the event of execution of a Definitive Agreement.

3.5. Third Party Software or Hardware Products

Third parties (including any affiliated parties) with which Contractor has a special business relationship and which provides functionality described in the requirements for this proposal or which extends functionality beyond native functionality of the delivered applications. For every product listed, include the name of the provider of the product (software/hardware), a description of the business relationship with Contractor, and a description of the product's functionality and fit with the proposed applications.

3.6. Supplemental Information

Provide any supplemental information, which is pertinent to the evaluation of the proposal, under this. The University will consider any additional suggestions if Contractor includes sufficient explanation and justification. If no supplemental information is to be included, the proposal should specify "none".

4. DETAILED SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

4.1. Required Information

All Contractors should provide the information as specified in Section 4.2 below. Only information received in response to this RFP will be evaluated. Reference to information previously submitted to the University will not be considered. **Failure to respond in full can be reason for rejecting the proposal in whole or in part at the discretion of the University.**

There is no intent to limit proposal content, and any supplemental data deemed pertinent may be included in the "Supplemental Information" section of Contractor's proposal.

In submitting a proposal, Contractor agrees that the proposal remains valid for one hundred eighty (180) calendar days after the closing date of submission of proposals and may be extended beyond that time by mutual agreement.

Strict compliance with this proposal format is essential to facilitate the evaluation process. Accordingly, the University of Pittsburgh reserves the right to reject any proposal which is either incomplete or does not conform to these instructions.

4.2. Proposal Format

The proposal should consist of the following completed documents:

Attachment G_ Inbound Freight Management Services RFP - Proposal Response Workbook
Attachment H_ Inbound Freight Management Services RFP – Pricing Proposal Workbook
Attachment I_ Inbound Freight Management Services RFP- Contracted Supplier Agreement (Agreed upon, or redlined copy)

Detailed proposal instructions/Information.

All proposal documents should be submitted as a copy of the original format the documents was sent in (Excel, Word) via email to jtr117@pitt.edu with a copy CC to ccyphert@cfo.pitt.edu. By noon Eastern on May 2, 2025.

It is the Contractor's responsibility to meet the deadlines established in this request and clarified during further discussions with the RFP administrator. Only Contractor's who can comply with this schedule need to submit proposals for consideration.

Failure to meet stated deliverable and availability dates before Contract award may result in the prospective Contractor's disqualification from the bidding process. After Contract award, failure to meet stated deliverable and or milestone dates will place Contractor in default and may result in disqualification.

5. AWARD CRITERIA

Award criteria will include, but are not limited to the following:

Pricing Proposal and pricing structure
Quality and Completeness of Proposal
Customer Service and Support Capabilities
Invoicing Accuracy and Technology Integration
Implementation Plan and Timeline
Demonstrated Ability to Meet University Requirements and Service Expectations
Strength of References
Value Add Services
Willingness to Accept University Standard Terms and Conditions

The University of Pittsburgh reserves the right to make the final decision regarding selection of Contractor(s). The awarding of Definitive Agreements to selected Contractor(s), if any, will be based solely on the judgment of the University of Pittsburgh.

Appendices and Attachments Overview

Note: *Except for Appendix C (embedded in this RFP), all other appendices are provided in Attachments G – Proposal Response Workbook and H – Pricing Proposal Workbook, or as a separate Excel attachment.*

Appendix A - Notification of Interest to Participate Form. Attached as Excel document titled: **Attachment A_Inbound Freight Management Services RFP – Notification of Interest to Participate Form.** Please complete the form in the original Excel format. Submit this document by itself (no additional files) via email to jtr117@pitt.edu and CC ccyphert@cfo.pitt.edu.

Appendix B – Submission Authorization Form. Located in Excel document titled: **Attachment G_ Inbound Freight Management Services RFP – Proposal Worksheet** (Section 6. Submission Authorization Form – RFP Appendix B)

Appendix C – Scope of Work. Embedded in this RFP document on page 16.

Appendix D - Contractor References. Located in Excel document titled: **Attachment G_ Inbound Freight Management Services RFP – Proposal Worksheet** (Section 7. Contractor References)

Appendix E – Contractor Analysis Request. Located in Excel document titled: **Attachment G_ Inbound Freight Management Services RFP – Proposal Worksheet** (Section 8. Contractor Analysis)

Appendix F – Supplier Verification Form/W9. Note: Contractors will receive a secure eSignature link for the University of Pittsburgh Supplier Verification/W9 form upon receipt of their initial notification of award.

Attachment G – Proposal Response Workbook. Sent as Excel document titled: **Attachment G_ Inbound Freight Management Services RFP - Proposal Response Workbook**

Attachment H – Pricing Proposal Workbook. Sent as Excel document titled: **Attachment H_ Inbound Freight Management Services RFP - Proposal Response Workbook**

Attachment I – Contracted Supplier Agreement. Sent as Word document titled: **Attachment I_ Inbound Freight Management Services RFP - Proposal Response Workbook**

APPENDIX C

Scope of Work

The Contractor shall provide discounted inbound freight transportation rates and administrative services under a managed inbound freight program. These two areas will be evaluated and priced separately to allow for a more precise comparison of offerings. However, Contractor's may choose to submit bundled proposals that include both service areas. This section outlines the required services in detail. All services must align with the University's goals outlined in Section 1 of the RFP and shall include the following deliverables:

1. Transportation Rates (Discounted Carrier Rates)

Contractor's must propose freight rates for small parcel and LTL services. These rates can be provided under a third-party reseller model and/or through access to existing aggregation/GPO agreements. The service fee should be added to each line item (shipment) on the invoice, so the fee can be charged to the appropriate cost center at the time of invoicing.

Contractor's are required to submit levels of pricing using the documents provided in **Attachment H_Inbound Freight Management Services RFP – Pricing Proposal Workbook**:

Standard Rate Table - UPS and FedEx (Small Parcel)

- Provide rates **for small parcel shipments** including and more, examples:
    - Ground
    - 2-Day
    - Overnight/Air Express
- Submit rates for each service level by weight tier or zone, if applicable.

LTL Pricing

- Submit rate tables by zone, weight, freight class, and delivery type
- Clearly identify base rates (e.g. CzarLite) and include breakdowns of:
    - Fuel surcharges
    - Accessorial fees
    - Residential/delivery area charges
    - Liftgate or inside delivery charges
    - Other applicable fees (e.g. FAK)

Net Pricing Sheet (Small Parcel)

- Provide a comprehensive "net rate sheet" showing net transportation rate per service level
- This should not include the service fee amount if you are bidding rates and services separately

Shipment Reprice File (Small Parcel and LTL)

- Complete the "Shipment Reprice File" provided as part of Attachment H.
- This file contains historical shipment data (origin, destination, weight, freight class, etc.)
- Vendors must price each shipment as if they had moved it under their program

2. Services (Fee per Transaction)

Contractor must propose a fee per transaction (i.e. per tracking number and PRO number) to cover the following administrative services and program support functions. These services will be evaluated based on quality, completeness, and alignment with University needs.

Multi-Carrier Support & Execution

- Manage inbound small parcel freight using both FedEx and UPS, under a third-party billing model.
- Support LTL routing and pricing models, with clear rate structures and accessorial charges disclosed.
- Coordinate execution of freight services regardless of carrier, ensuring consistency in tracking, invoicing, and service performance across multiple carriers.
- Provide integration capabilities to ensure routing and invoice processes function effectively in a multi-carrier environment.

Invoicing and Payment Services (Freight Audit and Pay)

- Allocate inbound freight charges to appropriate University cost centers based on purchase order or research account data.
- Provide a high invoice-to-PO match rate and a process for resolving unmatched shipments.
- Generate and submit weekly freight invoice files in a format compatible with the University's ERP system.
- Include setup and file transfer costs for integration in the proposed flat service fee.
- Support AP upload functionality, including file re-submission if rejections occur due to inactive GL codes or format issues.
- Clarify payment model (e.g., Supplier- or University-paid freight) and outline required responsibilities for both parties.
- Maintain internal records of freight payments and related transaction history.
- Apply basic audit checks to identify duplicate charges or other anomalies.
- Coordinate with carriers on payment-related inquiries and resolution.

Supplier Management & Program Support

- Lead the onboarding and conversion of non-participating suppliers to freight collect/third-party billing under University freight accounts.
- Maintain and update a validated list of compliant suppliers and coordinate regularly with the University to reconcile records.
- Provide support for supplier outreach, including delivery and reinforcement of routing instructions.
- Monitor and report vendor compliance with routing guide instructions and billing requirements.
- Define onboarding processes for new suppliers or departments, including expected timeline, required data, and technical integration needs.
- Address suppliers unwilling to convert and propose resolution strategies.
- Collaborate with the University to design and maintain a routing guide that will be hosted or accessible on the Supplier platform.
- Collaborate with the University project team in addressing non-compliant vendors or those unwilling to convert, including outreach support, data reconciliation, and escalation strategies.

Note* *Suppliers here refer to suppliers currently participating in or that may convert to the University's Inbound Freight Management Program.*

Reporting and Analytics

- Provide a web-based portal or software solution for shipment visibility, exception tracking, and reporting access.
- Deliver monthly reports on program participation, vendor compliance, cost savings, exceptions, and avoided costs.
- Include ad hoc reporting capabilities upon request and support trend analysis or strategic recommendations.
- Detail reporting cadence, format, and any differentiators (dashboards, visualizations, tools like Tableau or Power BI).

Customer Support & Claims Handling

- Assign a dedicated account manager as the primary point of contact for daily operations, issue resolution, and strategic guidance.
- Provide responsive customer support for escalated issues, freight disputes, vendor pushback, or system problems.
- Offer training, onboarding sessions, and educational resources for University stakeholders as needed.
- Provide continuity of service in case of workforce disruptions, strikes, or other critical supply interruptions.
- Support freight claims management, including loss or damage claims for small parcel and LTL shipments, and coordinate with carriers as needed.